

Types of data

There are several different types of data in Python. Most of the time, Python will work out what type is being used, but sometimes you'll need to change data from one type to another.

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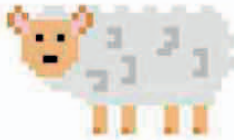
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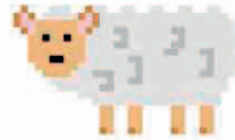
Numbers

Python has two data types for numbers. “Integers” are whole numbers, (numbers without a decimal point). “Floats” are numbers with a decimal point. An integer can be used to count things such as sheep, while a float can be used to measure things such as weight.



```
>>> sheep = 1
>>> print(sheep)
1
```

An integer
is a whole
number



```
>>> sheep = 1.5
>>> print(sheep)
1.5
```

1.5
is a float

△ Integers

An integer is a number without a decimal point, such as the 1 in the variable “sheep”.

△ Floats

A float is a number with a decimal point, such as 1.5. They aren't normally used to count whole objects.

Strings

Just like in Scratch, a piece of text in Python is called a “string”. Strings can include letters, numbers, spaces, and symbols such as full stops and commas. They are usually put inside single quote marks.

The string
in quotes

```
>>> a = 'Coding is fun!'
>>> print(a)
Coding is fun!
```

The value of
the variable “a”
printed out



Always remember that
strings need quote
marks at the start
and the end.

▷ Using a string

To assign a string to a variable, put the text inside single quote marks.